

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

How to Talk to AI — improv tips, a key for every student item, what-ifs, the AI-honesty discussion.



WHY THIS LESSON

A good AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**: a person starts it (the prompt) and a person ends it (the check). This lesson trains both, and it stands alone.

PLAYING THE WORST GENIE EVER

Three moves cover every wish: **take a word literally** ("rich" = a name), **fill the missing detail badly** (money = play money), or **grant it in the least useful form** (a hero story = "Once there was a hero. The end."). Stay cheerful — never mean, just literal. When a student adds a rule and you have to grant it properly, applaud it.

SAMPLE GENIE-PROOF REPAIRS (WORKSHEET P.1)

There is no single right answer — score with the Genie-Proof Checklist. Exemplars, with the twist each one blocks:

CURSED	EXEMPLAR REPAIR
Amara — "tell me about space" <i>Twist it blocked: 40 pages on NASA</i>	"I'm a 7th grader making a one-page science poster about black holes, due Friday. Give me 5 amazing facts, each under 20 words, written so a 5th grader could get it. No math formulas."
Mateo — "help me save money" <i>Twist it blocked: "Stop buying things."</i>	"I'm 12 and get \$15 a week. I want \$120 headphones in 10 weeks. Make a simple weekly savings plan as a table, and give 2 tips for not spending it on snacks."
Yuki — "make a story about a hero" <i>Twist it blocked: a one-line story</i>	"Write the opening paragraph (max 100 words) of an anime-style story about a shy kid whose sketchbook drawings come to life. Mysterious tone, end on a cliffhanger."

MODEL TWISTS (KEY FOR THE BREAK-IT PAGE)

A twist counts only if it obeys *every word* of the repaired wish. Two per exemplar — **Amara**: no "under 20 words" → each fact is a page; no "poster" → a 10-page report. **Mateo**: no time limit → a 40-year plan, 6 cents a week; no "simple" → a 30-column spreadsheet. **Yuki**: no length → one sentence again; no "anime-style" → a Western.

SCORING GUIDANCE (EACH REPAIR)

- **Proficient**: all three P.R.O. parts present and specific; partner-genie couldn't twist it.
- **Developing**: two parts, or vague ones ("make it short").
- **Beginning**: restated the cursed wish with more words.

✦ ANSWER KEY — WORKSHEET P.2 (BREAK IT + EXIT TICKET)

ITEM	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
Genie test row (✓ = genie-proof)	A ✓ is earned only if the partner tried a twist out loud and failed. Test against the exemplars: "5 facts under 20 words, no formulas" leaves nothing to twist; "some facts about space" can still become 40 pages. P, R and O checked but no Genie-test ✓ is a legitimate score — the rules were there but too loose.
Best (sneakiest) twist (the DOK-3 item)	Compare with Model Twists (p.1). Strong: names the wish + the missing rule + the twisted result ("Wish 2 — he never said how long, so: a 40-year plan"). Developing: a twist with no missing rule named. Redo: "make it weird" — a twist must obey every word.
Exit #1 — prompt for another class	Exemplar: "I'm in 6th grade math learning fractions. Make me 5 practice problems on adding fractions with different denominators, easy to hard, with the answers on a separate line. No decimals." Part two (the short version — "I'm in 6th grade math"): a good answer names the twist — "the genie would explain what 6th grade math is," or "it would give me random math with no fractions." Any answer that shows the SHORT prompt lets the genie choose is proficient; this is the item that measures Objective 1.
Exit #2 — the genie's black-hole answer	Planted fact: "the first-ever photo of a black hole in 2009" — false. The first image of a black hole (in galaxy M87, by the Event Horizon Telescope) was released in April 2019. Proficient = names that sentence AND a real source to check it (science textbook, NASA's website, a librarian, the school library database). Also accept a student who flags "even light can't escape" or "biggest ones sit in the middle of galaxies" — both are true, but they are checkable claims, and spotting a checkable claim is the skill. Not accepted: "I'd check it on AI."

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

Inappropriate wish in the warm-up → "The genie doesn't grant that one. Next wish." Don't repeat it, don't react.

A pair finishes Repair early → Extension: write a wish that CAN'T be genie-proofed in under 50 words and explain why.

Partner rubber-stamps every ✓ → make them say the twist out loud; no twist, the ✓ stands; a twist, uncheck it and write it down.

Same repair three times → "What does Mateo need that Yuki doesn't?" A plan is not a story — the O part must change.

Odd number of students → one group of three rotates sheets left; each genie scores one sheet.

"But the AI I use at home gets it right" → "Sometimes. Was that the AI reading your mind, or you getting lucky? Today we stop needing luck."

Live AI answer in the Showcase is bad → best case. "Which part of the wish let it do that?" Add a rule, run it again.

Exit #2: "it all sounds right" → "Which sentence has a number or a date in it? Start there." Never put the key on the projector.

✦ THE AI-HONESTY DISCUSSION (USE ANYTIME IT COMES UP)

Q: "Is using AI cheating?" — One sentence settles it: *AI is your editor, not your ghostwriter*. Feedback, brainstorming, checking understanding = editor. Handing in its work with your name on it = ghostwriter, and a wish you never earned. Ask: "What did YOU make?"

Q: "Is the AI always right?" — No. It predicts likely words; it can be confidently wrong ("hallucinate") — a trickster genie. Rule of thumb: anything that's a checkable fact (dates, numbers, names, quotes) gets checked against a real source before you use it.

Q: "Will AI take all the jobs?" — The honest answer: nobody knows, and say so. So far the clearest cases are tasks inside jobs, not whole jobs — nobody can promise the final count. A person who can direct an AI clearly and check what it hands back likely has an edge — and that is today's lesson.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: P.R.O. instruction (a prompt broken into Purpose / Requirements / Output). Assessed: the three wish repairs (worksheet p.1) and Exit Ticket #1, scored with the Scoring Guidance above.*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: the trickster rule that opens the Exit Ticket block and the "Is the AI always right?" discussion. Assessed: Exit Ticket #2 — students evaluate a printed sample AI answer, find the checkable claim and name where they would verify it.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1-3 above.) *Taught: the Purpose part (task + audience) and the Requirements part (style, length, tone). Assessed: wish repairs 1–3 + Exit Ticket #1.*

SUPPORT & ELL: P.R.O. SENTENCE STARTERS

P: "I am a ____ grader working on _____. I want ____ for _____."

R: "Keep it ____ (length). Use a ____ tone. Include _____. Do NOT _____."

O: "Give me the answer as a ____ (list / table / paragraph / steps)."

Support students may repair two wishes instead of three. ELL students may draft in their strongest language first, then translate — the starters double as language frames.

✦ THANK YOU & TERMS OF USE

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